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Journal options for the nationwide multidimensional segregation paper

Paper in one line. A nationwide, multidimensional, point-estimation description of racial residential segregation across 319 Brazilian cities (2022 Census, nine PySAL indices spanning the five Massey–Denton dimensions), with a fully reproducible pipeline. Its headline results: the evenness indices are near-redundant and South/Southeast lead on them (updating Sousa Filho et al. 2023 to 2022), but the exposure dimension inverts the regional ranking and “the most segregated city” has no dimension-independent answer.

What a reviewer will weigh. Strengths: newest census, genuinely multidimensional, open/reproducible, a clean conceptual point (one index is not enough). Weaknesses a reviewer may press on: it is descriptive (no inference, deferred), no temporal or individual-level data, the “contribution beyond Sousa Filho 2023” is incremental, and Relative Concentration is unreliable for majority-minority cities.

Metrics (impact factor, quartile, review time, APC) are approximate, as of early 2026. Verify current figures on each journal’s site before submitting.

Recommendation summary

Rank	Journal	Why
1 (primary)	Revista Brasileira de Estudos de Popula��o (REBEP)	The exact scholarly conversation this paper joins; the two papers it builds on are here; no fee; strong Qualis; the “update to Sousa Filho 2023” framing lands perfectly. Formatting overhead (Word, ABNT, trilingual, ≤5 illustrations) is the price.

Rank	Journal	Why
2 (English, methods-forward)	Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy	Best international home for a "nationwide spatially-explicit multi-city analysis" that isn't a new method; established, indexed, no reformat cost from the current LaTeX.
3 (English, demography-forward)	Demographic Research	Free, fast, prestigious in demography, wide readership — but selective, and it will want a sharper demographic (not just spatial) contribution.
Situational	Spatial Demography; Journal of Computational Social Science; Cadernos Metrópole; Caderno CRH; EURE	Good fits for specific framings — see profiles.

If your priority is ... the Brazilian debate and your Brazilian CV → **REBEP**. International visibility with least friction → **Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy**. Speed + open access + reach, and you're willing to sharpen the demographic angle → **Demographic Research**.

Decision matrix

Journal	Scope fit	Open access	APC	Typical 1st decision	Language	Reformat cost from current LaTeX	Audience
REBEP	★★★★★	Yes (diamond)	None	6–12 mo	PT/EN/ES	High (Word, ABNT, trilingual, ≤5 figs)	Brazilian demography/urban
Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy	★★★★	Hybrid	~US\$3,700 if OA; free if not	3–5 mo	EN	Low (Springer LaTeX)	Applied spatial analysts, planners
Demographic Research	★★★★½	Yes (diamond)	None	4–7 mo	EN	Medium (their template)	International demographers
Spatial Demography	★★★★½	Hybrid	~US\$3,000 if OA; free if not	4–8 mo (variable)	EN	Low	Spatial demographers (small)
Journal of Computational Social Science	★★★	Hybrid	~US\$3,300 if OA; free if not	3–5 mo	EN	Low	Computational social scientists

Journal	Scope fit	Open access	APC	Typical 1st decision	Language	Reformat cost from current LaTeX	Audience
Environment and Planning B: UACS	★★★	Hybrid	~US\$3,200 if OA; free if not	3–6 mo	EN	Low–medium (SAGE)	Urban analytics / big-data urban
Population, Space and Place	★★★	Hybrid	~US\$4,000 if OA; free if not	4–7 mo	EN	Low (Wiley)	Population geographers
Cadernos Metrópole	★★★	Yes (diamond)	None	4–9 mo	PT (EN/ES accepted)	Medium	Brazilian urban studies
Caderno CRH	★★½	Yes (diamond)	None	4–9 mo	PT	Medium	Brazilian sociology (race, work, city)
EURE	★★★	Yes (diamond)	None	6–12 mo	ES (EN/PT accepted)	Medium	Latin American urban/regional studies

“Diamond” = open access with no author fee.

Detailed profiles

1. Revista Brasileira de Estudos de População (REBEP)

- **Publisher / indexing.** ABEP (Associação Brasileira de Estudos Populacionais). SciELO, Scopus, Redalyc, DOAJ. Qualis CAPES A1 (Demografia / Planejamento Urbano). No JCR impact factor (SciELO metrics instead).
- **Scope fit.** Direct. Both predecessor papers are here: Sousa Filho et al. (2023, the nationwide D-only 2010 study you extend) and Barros & Feitosa (2024, São Paulo–London).
- **Format.** Word only; ABNT (NBR 6023/10520) author–date references; abstract ~200 words in **Portuguese, English and Spanish**; up to **5 illustrations**; 8,000-word cap; blind review with full anonymisation. A REBEP submission package (draft/rebep/) is already prepared, with the trilingual front matter drafted and a SUBMISSION.md checklist.

Pros - Speaks to exactly the audience that will cite it; the incremental-over-Sousa-Filho framing is a feature here, not a weakness. - Diamond open access — no fee, permanent free access, high SciELO visibility in Brazil and Latin America. - A1 Qualis is valuable for a Brazilian author’s evaluation (Lattes/CAPES). - Bilingual/trilingual publication broadens reach without you translating the body (REBEP arranges it post-acceptance). - Accepts descriptive demographic analysis; inference is not expected.

Cons - Low international citation impact and reach relative to Springer/Wiley/SAGE titles. - Real formatting labour: convert to Word + ABNT, cut 8 figures to 5, re-export figures as EPS/editable at 300 dpi, produce ES front matter, complete two REBEP forms. - Review can be slow (6–12 months is common for SciELO journals). - Portuguese-dominant editorial process; responses and proofs often in Portuguese (not a problem for you, but worth noting for co-authors).

Verdict. The natural home. Choose it if you want the paper embedded in the Brazilian literature and counted well on your Brazilian CV, and you accept the formatting overhead.

2. Applied Spatial Analysis and Policy (Springer)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI; JCR impact factor ≈ 2.5 –3; Scopus Q1 (Geography, Planning & Development). Established (since 2008).
- **Scope fit.** “Development and application of spatial analysis to social, economic and environmental problems, with a policy dimension.” A nationwide, spatially explicit, multi-city segregation analysis is squarely in scope.
- **Format.** Springer LaTeX template — minimal reformat from your current `draft_v5.tex`. No hard figure cap. Author–year references.

Pros - Best international fit for a paper that is an *application* of spatial methods at national scale rather than a new method — reviewers there expect exactly this shape. - Lowest friction: your LaTeX, your figures, your English text mostly carry over. - The reproducible pipeline is a recognised plus in this venue. - Free to publish (subscription route); OA optional. - Decent, stable impact and a readership of people who use these indices.

Cons - Expects a discernible **policy** hook — you would need a paragraph or two making the “what should planners/policymakers do with a multidimensional reading” argument explicit (currently only implicit). - Not a demography journal; the racial-inequality and Brazilian-formation framing has to be pitched as spatial-policy relevance, which slightly flattens it. - OA APC (~US\$3,700) is steep if you need gold OA; the free route is subscription-only. - Mid-tier impact — respectable, not prestige.

Verdict. The safest international target. Recommended fallback / co-primary with REBEP.

3. Demographic Research (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI; JCR impact factor ≈ 2 –2.5; Scopus Q1 (Demography). Fully open access, **no APC**, MPIDR-funded.
- **Scope fit.** All of formal, empirical and applied demography. Residential segregation and its measurement appear regularly. Has short formats (“Descriptive Finding”, “Research Material”) as well as full “Research Articles”.
- **Format.** Their own template (LaTeX or Word). Reasonably light. Fast production.

Pros - Free, open, and genuinely fast for the field (often a first decision in 4–7 months, and quick to appear online after acceptance). - Prestigious and widely read across international demography — good citation potential. - Would take a nationwide descriptive study; “Descriptive Finding” is a legitimate route if you keep it tight. - No fee at all.

Cons - Selective, with a meaningful desk-reject rate; the editors want a clear demographic contribution, not “we computed nine indices for Brazil.” - Will likely push you to foreground the **demographic** story (composition $\leftrightarrow$ exposure, the North/Northeast majority-minority structure, what this implies for contact and cumulative disadvantage) over the methods-comparison story. - Spatially explicit methods are welcome but not the journal’s centre of gravity; a reviewer may want more on mechanisms and less on index taxonomy. - Cross-sectional, no individual data — some reviewers there prefer more analytical leverage.

Verdict. High-value if you’re willing to re-angle the framing toward demography. Worth a pre-submission enquiry to the editors.

4. Spatial Demography (Springer)

- **Indexing / metrics.** Scopus; ESCI (not core SSCI); low/again-building impact. Publishes the spatial-analysis-of-population niche.
- **Scope fit.** Excellent on paper — Rey, Cortes & Knaap (2021), “Comparative Spatial Segregation Analytics,” is in this journal, and the editorial board knows the PySAL segregation framework you use.
- **Format.** Springer LaTeX — minimal reformat.

Pros - Tightest topical fit of any English journal; the reviewers will not need the PySAL framework explained. - Your prior work and network are here. - Free to publish (subscription route).

Cons - Small circulation and low visibility; a paper here is read by a narrow group. - The journal has had **irregular publication cadence** (a multi-year gap around 2018–2021); confirm it is actively publishing and on schedule before committing. - ESCI-only indexing means it counts less in some evaluation systems than SSCI titles. - Little “prestige” return relative to the effort.

Verdict. Reasonable if topical fit and a friendly review matter more than reach. Check the journal’s current activity first.

5. Journal of Computational Social Science (Springer)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI/ESCI; JCR impact factor $\approx 2\text{--}3$ (young journal, rising). Scopus Q1/Q2.
- **Scope fit.** Computational methods and large-scale data for social science. Your *cortes2020* (the PySAL segregation module paper) is here.
- **Format.** Springer LaTeX — minimal reformat.

Pros - The open, reproducible pipeline (package + scripts + pinned environment + one-command regeneration) is genuinely central to this journal’s values. - Author familiarity; the module paper’s readership overlaps. - Reasonably fast.

Cons - The journal rewards **methodological or computational novelty**. This paper applies an existing module to a new dataset; a reviewer may judge the computational contribution thin, especially with inference deferred. - The substantive racial-segregation contribution is not what this readership optimises for. - Would likely require reframing around “a reproducible computational workflow for nationwide multidimensional segregation measurement,” which stretches the paper.

Verdict. Only if you substantially expand the methods/workflow contribution.

6. Environment and Planning B: Urban Analytics and City Science (SAGE)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI; JCR impact factor $\approx 3.5\text{--}4.5$; Scopus Q1 (Urban Studies, Geography). High visibility.
- **Scope fit.** Urban analytics, spatial data science, quantitative urban research. Barros & Feitosa (2018), “Uneven geographies,” is in EPB.
- **Format.** SAGE template; author–year. Moderate reformat.

Pros - The strongest impact/visibility of the realistic options. - “Spatial data science applied to cities” is exactly the journal’s brand; the reproducibility angle fits. - Urban segregation is an established EPB topic.

Cons - Competitive; a high share of desk rejects. Reviewers expect novelty in *urban-analytics* terms — a new method, a new data source, a scale or resolution not seen before. A descriptive multi-city index comparison on public census aggregates may be judged “not novel enough for EPB.” - Leans toward big-data / computational / network-based urban work. - OA APC is high; free route is subscription.

Verdict. Aim here only if you can sharpen a methodological or data novelty claim. Higher risk, higher reward.

7. Population, Space and Place (Wiley)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI; JCR impact factor $\approx 3-4$; Scopus Q1 (Demography, Geography).
- **Scope fit.** Population geography — migration, mobility, life course, residential patterns, inequality in space.
- **Format.** Wiley template; light reformat.

Pros - Demography + geography readership; segregation and residential sorting are in scope. - Good international visibility.

Cons - The journal's centre of gravity is migration / mobility / life-course, often with individual-level or longitudinal data. A cross-sectional, area-level, descriptive index study is a weaker fit than at ASAP or Demographic Research. - Competitive; OA APC ~US\$4,000. - A reviewer may ask for analytical leverage the data cannot provide.

Verdict. Possible but not a natural fit; lower on the list.

8. Cadernos Metrópole (PUC-SP)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SciELO, Scopus, Redalyc, DOAJ. Qualis A1. Diamond open access.
- **Scope fit.** Urban and metropolitan studies in Brazil and Latin America. Gonçalves & Strauch (2026), "Segregação racial em Belo Horizonte," is here.
- **Format.** Word; Portuguese preferred (English/Spanish accepted). ABNT.

Pros - Brazilian urban-studies audience, strong Qualis, no fee. - The racialised-space and center-periphery framing is native to this journal. - An alternative to REBEP if you want an urban-studies rather than demography home.

Cons - More sociological / planning-oriented; heavy quantitative-index detail may not suit the readership. Reviewers will want more urban-process interpretation and historical framing, less methods taxonomy. - Portuguese-dominant; similar formatting overhead to REBEP. - Lower quantitative-methods credibility signal than a demography or spatial-analysis title.

Verdict. A solid Brazilian alternative if the paper leans more "urban inequality" than "segregation measurement." Otherwise REBEP is the better Brazilian choice.

9. Caderno CRH (UFBA)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SciELO, Scopus, Redalyc. Qualis A1. Diamond open access.
- **Scope fit.** Sociology of work, urban sociology, race and inequality in Brazil. França (2022), "Segregação residencial por raça e classe em Fortaleza, Salvador e São Paulo," is here.
- **Format.** Word; Portuguese; ABNT.

Pros - Race and urban inequality are central to this journal; the political/structural framing is welcome. - No fee, A1 Qualis, open access.

Cons - A sociology journal — a nine-index spatial-measurement paper is methodologically heavier than its usual content, and reviewers will want a stronger sociological/ theoretical contribution. - Portuguese only; formatting overhead. - Least methods-friendly of the Brazilian options.

Verdict. Only if you substantially rewrite toward a sociological argument about racial inequality, with the indices in a supporting role.

10. EURE (Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile)

- **Indexing / metrics.** SSCI; JCR impact factor $\approx 1-1.5$; Scopus Q2 (Urban Studies). Diamond open access. The leading Latin American urban/regional studies journal.
- **Scope fit.** Urban and regional studies across Latin America; comparative and single-country. Accepts Spanish, Portuguese and English.
- **Format.** Their template; Spanish-dominant process. ABNT-like.

Pros - SSCI-indexed regional journal — more international credit than a SciELO-only title. - Latin American comparative urban framing would be welcomed if foregrounded. - No fee, open access.

Cons - Broad urban-studies readership, not a segregation-methods audience. - Spanish-dominant editorial process; you'd likely submit and revise in Spanish or accept a translation step. - Review times can be long. - Would want the "Latin American city" narrative pushed to the front, changing the paper's emphasis.

Verdict. A regional option with SSCI indexing; middling fit for the paper as written.

Also considered (briefly)

- **SN Social Sciences (Springer).** Broad social-science journal; deSousaFilho et al. (2022, income segregation in Brazilian cities) is here. Fast, less selective, but APC-funded (~US\$1,700), lower prestige, "megajournal" perception. A backstop, not a target.
 - **Regional Studies, Regional Science (Taylor & Francis).** Open, short-format, quick. Possible for a condensed version, but limited depth and reach.
 - **Journal of Maps.** Only if reframed around the cartography, which this paper is not.
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Practical notes

1. **One journal at a time.** Do not submit in parallel; it is grounds for rejection at all of them.
2. **Two ready tracks.** The paper is already in submittable shape for the Springer LaTeX journals (ASAP, Spatial Demography, JCSS) with near-zero reformat. The REBEP track needs the SUBMISSION.md checklist worked through.
3. **Figure count.** REBEP and Cadernos Metrópole cap illustrations at 5; the current 8 figures must be merged/cut for those. The Springer/SAGE/Wiley journals have no hard cap.
4. **Policy paragraph.** For ASAP (and to strengthen any submission), add an explicit paragraph on what a multidimensional reading implies for housing and urban policy.
5. **Pre-submission enquiry.** For Demographic Research and EPB:UACS, a short email to the editor with the abstract is worth the day it costs — both have high desk-reject rates and the reply tells you whether to invest in the reformat.
6. **If REBEP is the choice:** confirm with the IntechOpen book editors (the original chapter venue) that publishing this as a REBEP article is acceptable and that the chapter, if still going ahead, will be sufficiently different.